

HERITAGE REPORT

ADDRESSED TO THE EASTERN CAPE PROVINCIAL HERITAGE RESOURCES AUTHORITY (ECPHRA)

In respect of an application in terms of Section 38 of the National Heritage Resources Act, Act 25 of 1999

THE PROPOSED WALMER HOUSING DEVELOPMENT ON ERF 11305, WALMER, GQEBERHA (NELSON MANDELA BAY MUNICIPALITY), EASTERN CAPE



Figure 1: SPLUMA-approved Rezoning and Subdivision Plan for Erf 11305, Walmer (Metroplan, drawing DYB-Y-28. (Source: Abantu Environmental Services)

PREPARED FOR

Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality (Applicant)

c/o Abantu Environmental Services (Pty) Ltd — Environmental Assessment Practitioner

PREPARED BY



04 August 2026 | Revision 02

DATE	ISSUED DESCRIPTION	REVISION
03 August 2026	Draft built-environment HIA (specialist input to the EIA)	01
04 August 2026	Expanded HIA — built heritage, morphological history, significance and stakeholder engagement	02

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

NO	ITEM	DESCRIPTION
1	Site and project name	The proposed Walmer Housing Development on Erf 11305, Walmer, Gqeberha, within the Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality (NMBM), Eastern Cape Province.
2	Location	West of the established Walmer suburb, along Victoria Drive, approximately 4 km south of the Gqeberha city centre. The ±43.73 ha erf is bordered by Walmer Heights to the north-west, the Walmer Golf Club to the north/east, the former Arlington Race Course to the south-west, and Walmer Township to the south-east. Surveyor-General 21-digit code C059003800130500000; Registration Division Port Elizabeth; Ward 1.
3	Locality plan	See Figure 1 (SPLUMA-approved subdivision plan), Figure 2 (locality) and Figures 4–7 (historical maps, aerials and the built-environment features).
4	Description of the proposed development	A Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality mixed-housing development providing approximately 952 residential opportunities (652 single dwellings and 300 high-density units) across Free Basic House/RDP (BNG), GAP/FLISP, social and open-market typologies, together with business, institutional, open-space, special-use conservation (forest-patch) and transport zones, internal roads and services. The preferred layout avoids the on-site forest patches.
5	Heritage resources identified	Six heritage resources are recognised: (QBE1) an overgrown dipping tank; (QBE2) a minor ruin; (QBE3) the principal farmstead ruin, with surviving foundations and a stone chimney; (QBE4) a contemporary substation of no significance; the historical association of the site to the Welbedacht farm and the Muller family and the founding of Walmer; and the surviving commonage, garden-planting and tree-grove landscape. The built structures are the focus of this report.
6	Composite statement of significance	Erf 11305 is a modestly significant heritage resource, valued chiefly for its historical and social/economic association with the founding of Walmer and its long use as commonage and garden-planting land. These values are modest, largely non-physical, and held today by a relatively small community of descendants and interest parties. The structures (QBE2 and QBE3) are older than 60 years but of low significance; if graded they would remain ungraded.
7	Anticipated impacts on heritage resources	The development entails extensive site clearance and the demolition of the ruins. As the physical heritage resources are of low–medium value, the anticipated negative impact is minimal and readily mitigable. There is no built-environment heritage fatal flaw.
8	Recommendations	Support authorisation subject to: (i) A Section 38 demolition permit from ECPHRA for QBE2 and QBE3 (older than 60 years), preceded by photographic and archival recording; (ii) Archaeological and palaeontological chance-find protocols and ECO heritage induction.
9	Author and date	Bryan Wintermeyer (Professional Architect SACAP 6591; Accredited Professional Heritage Practitioner APHP PHP0077; M.Phil. Conservation of the Built Environment, UCT), 04 August 2026.

1 INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND

This report is a Heritage Impact Assessment (HIA) prepared in response to Section 38 of the National Heritage Resources Act, Act 25 of 1999 (the NHRA). It concerns the proposed Walmer Housing Development on Erf 11305, Walmer, Gqeberha, within the Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality (NMBM). It provides the information required for an Eastern Cape Provincial Heritage Resources Authority (ECPHRA) assessment and serves as the built-environment heritage specialist input to the concurrent Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA).

This report describes the heritage resources and their significance and assesses the impact of the proposed development upon them. It builds on, and consolidates, the earlier heritage and archaeological work undertaken for this site, and extends it into a detailed assessment of the built environment, which is the focus of this report.

The Applicant is the Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality. The EIA process is managed by the Environmental Assessment Practitioner (EAP), Abantu Environmental Services (Pty) Ltd (Mr Sive Mlamla, Pr.Sci.Nat, registered EAP).¹

1.1 Property Owner Context

The land is owned by the Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality. It is municipal land; no land acquisition is required, and there is no displacement of private owners or occupiers.

1.2 Approval Context For This Work

This report forms part of a larger approval context driven by an EIA process. It responds to the need for a Section 38 heritage assessment under the NHRA and simultaneously constitutes a specialist report within the EIA. Other specialist inputs include a Palaeontological Impact Assessment (the palaeontological sensitivity of the site being Very High), an Archaeological and Cultural Heritage Impact Assessment, and biodiversity, aquatic, agricultural and socio-economic studies.

The EIA is undertaken under DEDEAT reference ECm1/C/LN2/M/07-2026. The development was previously authorised on 31 July 2019 under reference ECm1/C/LN2/M/39-2014; that authorisation has since lapsed, and a fresh Scoping and EIA application has been lodged.²

1.3 Scope Of Work And The Terms Of Reference

The Workplace Agency has been appointed to identify and map the heritage resources on and adjacent to the site; to assess their significance in terms of Section 3 of the NHRA; to describe the built environment in detail; to assess the impact of the proposed development; and to recommend management, mitigation and monitoring. The earlier Scoping Report set the terms of reference for a historical-structures assessment, namely to:

- determine whether the structures within the development area are older than 60 years;
- assess the sensitivity and significance of the structures and any impact on local communities; and
- determine whether a permit is required from ECPHRA to demolish the structures for development purposes.

¹ Abantu Environmental Services (Pty) Ltd, Final Scoping Report: Walmer Housing Development on Erf 11305 (DEDEAT ref. ECm1/C/LN2/M/07-2026), 13 April 2026; and SRK Consulting, Final Scoping Report, 2015.

² Abantu Environmental Services (Pty) Ltd, Final Scoping Report: Walmer Housing Development on Erf 11305 (DEDEAT ref. ECm1/C/LN2/M/07-2026), 13 April 2026; and SRK Consulting, Final Scoping Report, 2015.

This report responds to those terms of reference, and further responds to Appendix 6 of the 2014 EIA Regulations (specialist reports).³

1.4 Statement Of Independence Of The Heritage Practitioner

Bryan Wintermeyer, the built-environment heritage specialist, has no financial or other personal interest in the project other than the fair professional remuneration for the preparation of this report. He was appointed on a strictly professional basis to conduct this assessment in line with the NHRA. He is a registered Professional Architect (SACAP Reg. No. 6591) and an Accredited Professional Heritage Practitioner (APHP PHP0077), holds an M.Phil. in Conservation of the Built Environment (University of Cape Town, 2015, with distinction), and has more than fifteen years of full-time built-environment heritage experience.

1.5 Information Sources And Methodology

This report was prepared using existing current and historical reports, a literature and archival review, the environmental documentation prepared by others under NEMA, and a site inspection. Principal sources include:

- Booth, C. (2014), Phase 1 Archaeological Impact Assessment, Erf 11305, Walmer.⁴
- Abantu Environmental Services (2026) and SRK Consulting (2015), Final Scoping Report.⁵
- Early cadastral map of Walmer (NMBM Digitising Project, 2009) and 1939 aerial photography (Gerrie Horn).⁶
- Harradine, M., Port Elizabeth; Lorimer, E.K., Panorama of Port Elizabeth; Picton-Seymour, D., Historical Buildings in South Africa.⁷
- Heritage Western Cape grading guidance; Getty Conservation Institute values-based literature; and other archival and internet resources.

A site visit was undertaken. The assessment considered the four recorded built-environment features, the surviving evidence of garden planting and tree groves, and the general condition and setting of the property. Reference is made throughout to the Booth (2014) archaeological assessment as a key document.

1.6 Limitations

This report is limited by its scope as a Phase 1 built-environment HIA and by the terms of reference above. The formal public participation process is conducted by the EAP as part of the EIA (see chapter 3). The dating of the structures is inferred from map evidence, aerial photography and the physical fabric, in the absence of original drawings.

³ Appendix 6 of the Environmental Impact Assessment Regulations, 2014 (as amended), under the National Environmental Management Act, Act 107 of 1998.

⁴ C. Booth, A Phase 1 Archaeological Impact Assessment (AIA) for the proposed Walmer Gqeberha Low-Cost Housing Development on Erf 11305, Walmer, Port Elizabeth, NMBM, prepared for SRK Consulting, September 2014.

⁵ Abantu Environmental Services (Pty) Ltd, Final Scoping Report: Walmer Housing Development on Erf 11305 (DEDEAT ref. ECm1/C/LN2/M/07-2026), 13 April 2026; and SRK Consulting, Final Scoping Report, 2015.

⁶ Early cadastral map of Walmer indicating the subdivision of the Welbedacht (Welbedagt) property among the Muller heirs; source: NMBM Digitising Project, 2009.

⁷ M. Harradine, Port Elizabeth (Historical Society of Port Elizabeth); E.K. Lorimer, Panorama of Port Elizabeth (Balkema, 1971); South African History Online, "Port Elizabeth Timeline 1799–1986"; corroborated by contemporary Eastern Province Herald reports.

2 LEGISLATIVE AND CONCEPTUAL CONTEXT

This chapter sets out the legislative framework, the conceptual framework within which heritage is understood, and the approval processes. Any work on this property must be undertaken with regard to the NHRA, the National Building Regulations, applicable SANS documentation, and the relevant town-planning instruments (including the SPLUMA approval already obtained).

The notion of heritage begins in the Constitution. Section 24 provides that everyone has the right to an environment protected for present and future generations through reasonable measures that promote conservation while securing justifiable economic and social development. The NHRA gives effect to this in the heritage sphere; its preamble seeks an integrated system for the identification, assessment and management of the national estate, to be bequeathed to future generations.⁸

2.1 Section 38 — Heritage Impact Assessment

The proposed development triggers Section 38. Given the scale and nature of the works — the subdivision and development of a ±43.73 ha erf, with internal roads and services well in excess of 300 m — the following categories apply:

- Section 38(1)(a): the construction of a road, wall, powerline, pipeline, canal or other linear development exceeding 300 m in length;
- Section 38(1)(c)(i): any development or activity which will change the character of a site exceeding 5 000 m² in extent; and
- Section 38(1)(c)(ii): any development involving three or more existing erven or subdivisions thereof.

Section 38(3) specifies the required content of the heritage report. The table below cross-references each requirement to the relevant chapter.⁹

REQUIREMENT (NHRA s38(3))	WHERE ADDRESSED
(a) Identification and mapping of all heritage resources in the area affected.	Chapters 5 and 6.
(b) Assessment of the significance of such resources in terms of section 3(3).	Chapter 6.
(c) Assessment of the impact of the development on such resources.	Chapter 8.
(d) Evaluation of that impact relative to the sustainable social and economic benefits of the development.	Chapter 8.
(e) The results of consultation with affected communities and interested parties.	Chapter 3.
(f) If heritage resources will be adversely affected, the consideration of alternatives.	Chapters 6, 7 and 8.
(g) Plans for mitigation of adverse effects during and after completion.	Chapters 8 and 9.

⁸ Republic of South Africa, National Heritage Resources Act, Act 25 of 1999, Preamble.

⁹ National Heritage Resources Act 25 of 1999, Section 38(3).

2.2 Compliance With Specialist-Report Criteria

As a specialist input to an EIA, this report is structured to satisfy Appendix 6 of the 2014 EIA Regulations¹⁰ and to withstand review against the DEA and DP *Guideline for the Review of Specialist Input in EIA Processes*¹¹. The mapping below demonstrates this.

APPENDIX 6 REQUIREMENT	WHERE ADDRESSED
(a)–(b) Specialist details, expertise and declaration of independence.	Sections 1.4–1.5; Annexure 4.
(c)–(cA) Scope, purpose, quality and age of base data.	Sections 1.2–1.5.
(cB) Existing impacts, cumulative impacts and levels of acceptable change.	Sections 4.1, 8.3.
(d)–(e) Date and season of investigation; methodology.	Section 1.5.
(f)–(h) Site sensitivity, site plan, alternatives and sensitivity map.	Chapters 4, 6, 7; Figures 1, 3–7.
(i)–(j) Assumptions, uncertainties, findings and implications.	Sections 1.6, 5, 6.
(k)–(m) Mitigation, conditions and monitoring for the EMPr/EA.	Sections 8.5, 9.
(n) Reasoned opinion on whether the activity should be authorised.	Chapter 9.
(o)–(p) Consultation undertaken and comments received.	Chapter 3.

2.3 Defining Cultural Significance

In the NHRA, "cultural significance" includes "aesthetic, architectural, historical, scientific, social, spiritual, linguistic or technological value or significance".¹² The attributes that establish a resource as part of the national estate include importance in the community or pattern of South Africa's history, possession of rare aspects of cultural heritage, aesthetic characteristics valued by a community, and strong association with a particular community.¹³

2.4 Who Is The Community Related To The Heritage Resource?

The composition of the "community" attached to a resource is an important contemporary heritage question. The premise is that heritage is intrinsically linked to an individual or group, and without that link there is arguably no heritage. For this site, the interested communities are those connected to the history and development of Walmer — including descendants of the Muller and related families, the Historical Society and the Genealogy Society, and the broader community of the Walmer Township. Their claim is largely to the history and development of the site as recorded in maps and archival sources, rather than to specific structures or tree rows.

2.5 Economic Value

Of particular relevance to the developmental state is heritage's economic value and obligation. The NHRA's general principles require that the management of heritage resources contribute to social and economic development.¹⁴ The

¹⁰ Appendix 6 of the Environmental Impact Assessment Regulations, 2014 (as amended), under the National Environmental Management Act, Act 107 of 1998.

¹¹ Keatimilwe, K. & Ashton, P.J., *Guideline for the Review of Specialist Input in EIA Processes*, Edition 1, DEA&DP / CSIR, June 2005.

¹² National Heritage Resources Act 25 of 1999, Section 2 (definition of "cultural significance").

¹³ Attributes paraphrased from Section 3(3), National Heritage Resources Act 25 of 1999.

¹⁴ National Heritage Resources Act 25 of 1999, Section 5 (General Principles): the management of heritage resources must contribute to social and economic development.

Getty Conservation Institute observes that economic factors shape the possibilities of conservation practice by influencing decisions, policy and financing.¹⁵ Mason distinguishes "use" (market) values from "non-use" (non-market) values, the latter capturing socio-cultural and "public-good" value.¹⁶ In this case the substantial social and economic value of delivering affordable housing on public land is a central consideration to be weighed against a modest heritage cost.

2.6 The Approval Authority

The heritage approval authority is the Eastern Cape Provincial Heritage Resources Authority (ECPHRA), under the Department of Sport, Recreation, Arts and Culture (DSRAC). The concurrent environmental authorisation is administered by DEDEAT.

¹⁵ Getty Conservation Institute, *Economics and Heritage Conservation*, Los Angeles, 1998; and Avrami, E., Mason, R. & de la Torre, M., *Values and Heritage Conservation*, Getty Conservation Institute, 2000.

¹⁶ R. Mason distinguishes "use" (market) values from "non-use" (non-market) values, the latter reflecting socio-cultural and "public good" value.

3 STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT AND PUBLIC PARTICIPATION

This chapter records the consultation with communities and interested and affected parties (I and APs) regarding the impact of the development on heritage resources, as required by Section 38(3)(e) of the NHRA.

3.1 The Formal Public Participation Process

Because this heritage report is a specialist input to a Scoping and EIA process, the formal public participation process (PPP) is conducted by the EAP, Abantu Environmental Services, in accordance with the 2014 EIA Regulations. Notice of the environmental application is given to the relevant organs of state and I and APs, including DEDEAT, ECPHRA, the Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality, and adjoining landowners and community structures. This report will be included, in full, in the environmental report placed for public and authority comment.¹⁷

3.2 Summary And Conclusion

The heritage component is consulted upon through the established EIA public participation process managed by the EAP, supplemented by targeted engagement with heritage stakeholders through the NID/Section 38 process. As the heritage significance of the site is modest and the findings are not contentious, no objection on built-environment heritage grounds is anticipated. Any heritage comment received (in particular from the Mandela Bay Heritage Trust) will be recorded and addressed on finalisation.

¹⁷ Abantu Environmental Services (Pty) Ltd, Final Scoping Report: Walmer Housing Development on Erf 11305 (DEDEAT ref. ECm1/C/LN2/M/07-2026), 13 April 2026; and SRK Consulting, Final Scoping Report, 2015.

4 THE SITE, LOCATION AND SURVEY INFORMATION

The site is Erf 11305, Walmer, Gqeberha — a ±43.73 ha parcel of vacant, undeveloped municipal land on the western edge of the established Walmer suburb.

4.1 Location And Context

The property lies along Victoria Drive, approximately 4 km south of the Gqeberha city centre. It is bordered by the suburb of Walmer Heights to the north-west, the Walmer Golf Club to the north and east, the former Arlington Race Course to the south-west, and the Walmer Township to the south-east. The Chief Dawid Stuurman International Airport and the Port Elizabeth–Avontuur narrow-gauge railway lie to the north; Victoria Drive continues south to Schoenmakerskop on the coast. Access is from Victoria Drive (south) and from Glendour Road linking Beethoven Drive (north).

The central coordinates are approximately 33°59'53"S, 25°34'20"E.



Figure 2: Locality and access, showing the study-area boundary against the surrounding suburbs, golf course and township. (Source: Abantu Environmental Services, 2026.)

The site comprises vacant land subject to various informal uses (illegal dumping, grazing, informal tracks and sports fields) and contains patches of Critically Endangered Algoa Sandstone Fynbos and Southern Cape (Sardinia) forest thicket, which the preferred layout retains as conservation open space.

4.2 Property Information

PROJECT ASPECT	DESCRIPTION
District / Local Municipality	Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality
Registration Division	Port Elizabeth
Ward	1
Erf number	Erf 11305, Walmer
Surveyor-General 21-digit code	C059003800130500000
Extent (development footprint)	±43.73 ha
Registered owner	Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality
Nearest city	Gqeberha (formerly Port Elizabeth)

5 HISTORICAL CONTEXT

This chapter provides the historical context of the site and the larger region, drawing on the archaeological and historical background in the Booth (2014) assessment, published local histories, early cadastral maps and aerial photography.

5.1 The Pre-Colonial Landscape

The wider region carries a deep pre-colonial history. The site lies on the boundary of the generally accepted five-kilometre archaeologically sensitive coastal zone, within a landscape showing evidence of human occupation over a possible 1.5 million years, spanning the Early, Middle and Later Stone Ages. Over the last two thousand years the area was occupied by Khoekhoen pastoralists, attested regionally by earthenware pottery and, along the coast, by shell middens.¹⁸

This indigenous presence is legible in the region's toponymy: "Gqeberha" — since 2021 the official name of the city — is the isiXhosa name of both the Baakens River and the Walmer township adjoining this site.¹⁹

5.2 The Farm Welbedacht And The Founding Of Walmer

The recorded history of the site begins with the farm Welbedacht (Welbedagt, "well-considered"), granted in 1815 to Anthonie Michael Muller under Lord Charles Somerset, covering just under fourteen square miles to the south-west of the young town of Port Elizabeth. When Muller died in 1845 the farm passed to his eight sons, who could not agree how to subdivide it; the farm was accordingly sold and the proceeds distributed among the heirs.²⁰

In the early 1850s a portion of Welbedacht was laid out as a township. It was to have been named "Muller's Town", but following the death of the Duke of Wellington at Walmer Castle in 1852 — the Castle being the seat of the Lord Warden of the Cinque Ports — the surveyor (probably Mr D. MacDonald) proposed the name "Walmer" as a token of respect. In 1855 the area was transferred to the municipality of Port Elizabeth and formally named Walmer; on 8 March 1855 it was resolved to sell four hundred plots by public auction. Stands were reserved for the Dutch Reformed Church and the Anglican Church, and the village plan provided for wide streets and a plentiful water supply.²¹

Walmer developed as a genteel residential village and was awarded separate municipal status in 1899 (its Town Hall foundation stone was laid in 1908). A short suburban branch railway opened in 1906 but was abandoned in 1928. The Walmer Golf Club — "Little Walmer", one of the oldest golf clubs in the country — was founded in 1897 on the site's northern boundary, and the Arlington Race Course lay to the east. Walmer retained its independence until the mid-1960s, when it was absorbed into the Port Elizabeth municipality.²²

5.3 Morphological Development Of The Site

Early cadastral mapping records the ownership and subdivision of the site with clarity. The 1815 grant to A.M. Muller is annotated on the map (Figure 4), and above it the new town of Walmer is set out. In the south-western quadrant a

¹⁸ C. Booth, A Phase 1 Archaeological Impact Assessment (AIA) for the proposed Walmer Gqeberha Low-Cost Housing Development on Erf 11305, Walmer, Port Elizabeth, NMBM, prepared for SRK Consulting, September 2014.

¹⁹ Department of Sport, Arts and Culture name-change notice, gazetted 23 February 2021; "Gqeberha" is the isiXhosa name of both the Walmer township and the Baakens River.

²⁰ M. Harradine, Port Elizabeth (Historical Society of Port Elizabeth); E.K. Lorimer, *Panorama of Port Elizabeth* (Balkema, 1971); South African History Online, "Port Elizabeth Timeline 1799–1986"; corroborated by contemporary Eastern Province Herald reports.

²¹ M. Harradine, Port Elizabeth (Historical Society of Port Elizabeth); E.K. Lorimer, *Panorama of Port Elizabeth* (Balkema, 1971); South African History Online, "Port Elizabeth Timeline 1799–1986"; corroborated by contemporary Eastern Province Herald reports.

²² M. Harradine, Port Elizabeth (Historical Society of Port Elizabeth); E.K. Lorimer, *Panorama of Port Elizabeth* (Balkema, 1971); South African History Online, "Port Elizabeth Timeline 1799–1986"; corroborated by contemporary Eastern Province Herald reports.

series of clearly recognisable erven were allocated from the 1850s onwards to the Muller heirs — including H. Muller, J.A. Muller, I.T. Muller, J. Muller and P.H. Muller (Erven 1A–7G). The boundaries of these historical properties remain visible today in current erf boundaries, and on site as fence lines and vegetation. The area to the south-east, today the Walmer Township, is annotated as the "Walmer Commonage"; this area and the south-western quadrant that includes the present site were used periodically as commonage — pastoral land for animals and for the growing of vegetables and other planting.²³

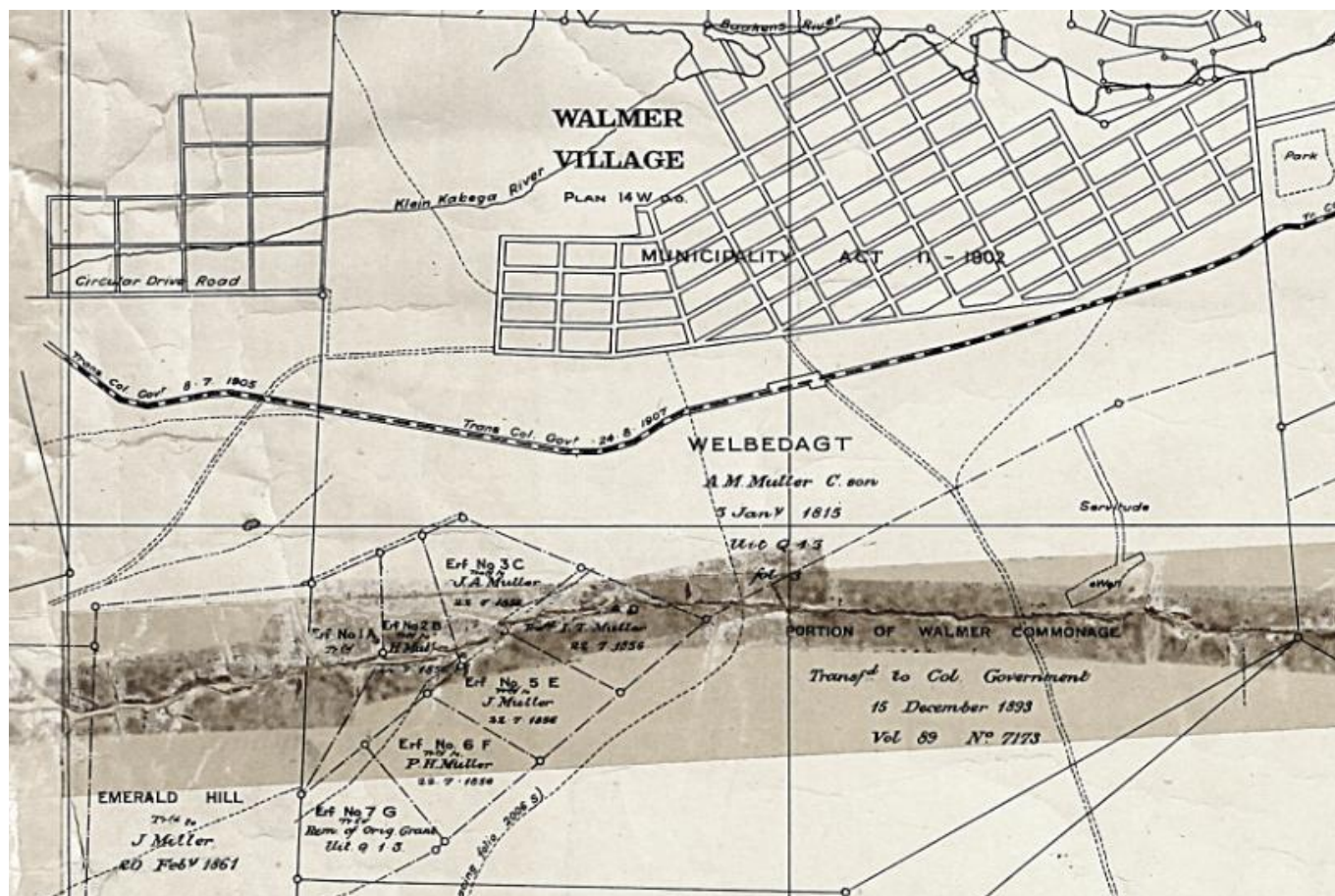


Figure 4: Early cadastral map of Walmer, showing "WELBEDAGT — A.M. Muller C. son, 3 Jany 1815", the subdivision of the property among the Muller heirs (Erven 1A–7G), Walmer Village, and the "Portion of Walmer Commonage" transferred to the Colonial Government on 15 December 1893. (Source: NMBM Digitising Project, 2009.)

Aerial photography of 1939 (Figure 5) shows the rapid development of Walmer to the north, with indigenous bush to the south and the clearing of the site for planting and farming. Regular lines of planting to the east of the site — probably windbreaks, and contemporary with the trees planted throughout the Walmer suburb from around 1900 — are still visible on the site today. A structure is evident at QBE3, with several small structures extending westwards from it. Victoria Drive, connecting Walmer to Schoenmakerskop on the coast, is visible.²⁴

²³ Early cadastral map of Walmer indicating the subdivision of the Welbedacht (Welbedagt) property among the Muller heirs; source: NMBM Digitising Project, 2009.

²⁴ 1939 aerial photograph of the site; source: Gerrie Horn collection.

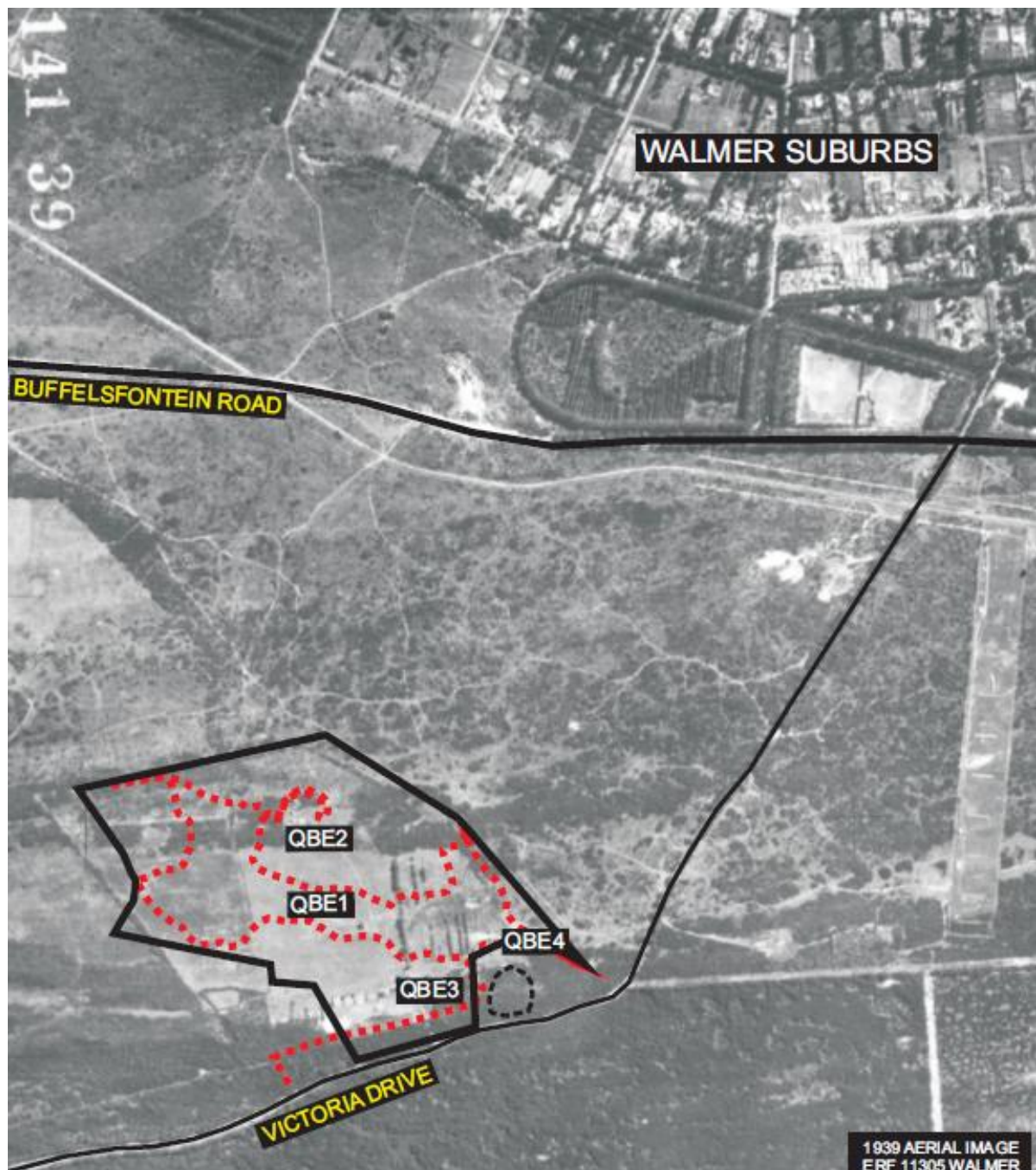


Figure 5: 1939 aerial photograph, showing the study-area boundary and the four recorded features (QBE1–QBE4), the developing Walmer suburbs to the north, Buffelsfontein Road and Victoria Drive. (Source: WP)

The photographic and physical evidence suggests that the site has been used intermittently since the subdivisions of the 1850s onwards, principally for minor commonage, farming and agricultural activity. The lines of trees to the east are contemporary with much of the tree-planting in the Walmer suburb, from around 1900.

The most significant surviving structure is at QBE3: from its materials, structural methods and detailing (brickwork and concrete, the style of roof tile and the bathroom wall tile), it is suggested to have been built, at the earliest, in the 1930s. Its layout — an approach and veranda to the north, a kitchen to the rear and evidence of an outside toilet — suggests a modest residence, now abandoned and in ruins. There is no clear evidence of older structures, although some remains of modest service structures related to the site’s activities are likely.

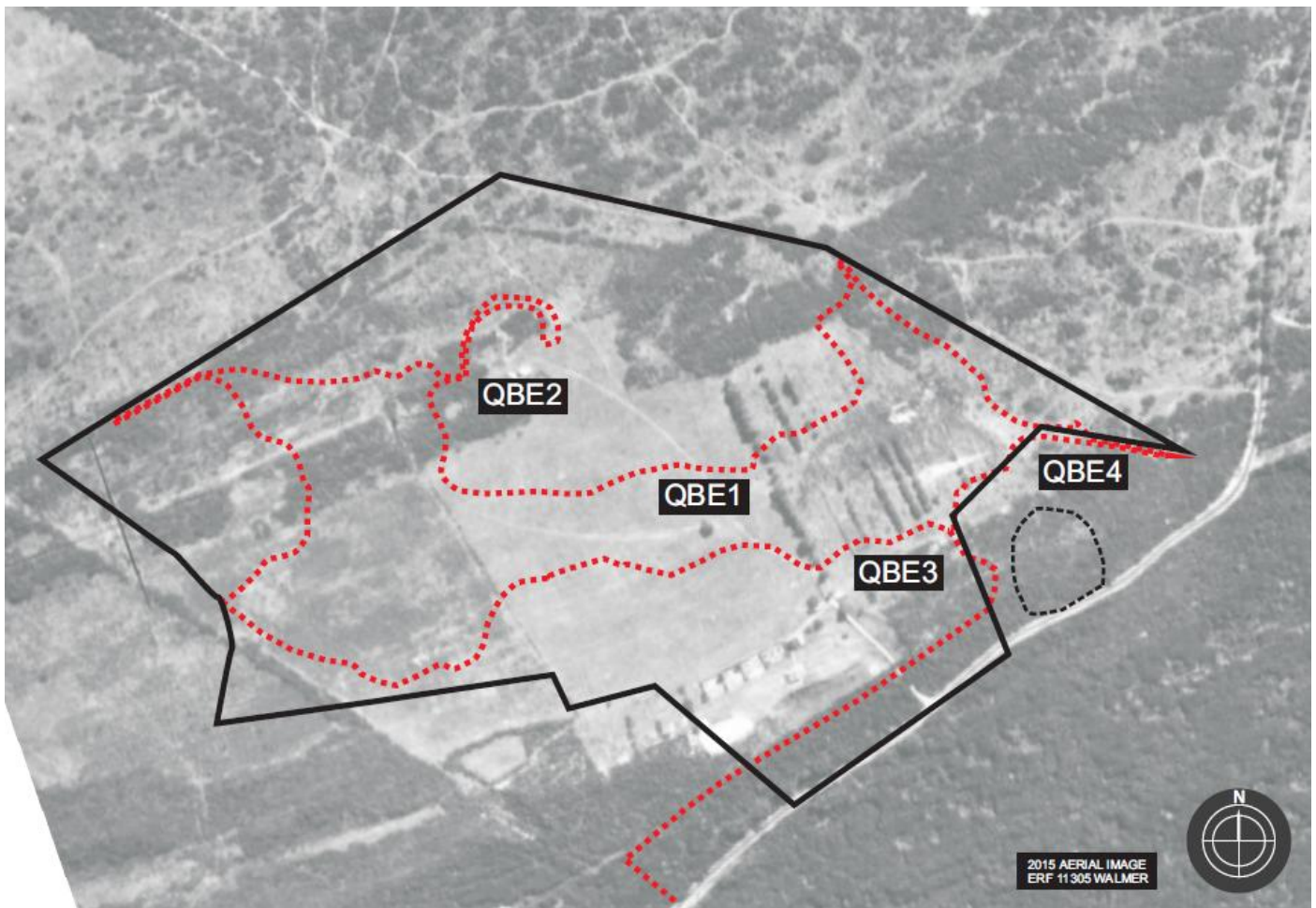


Figure 6: Recent aerial photograph of the study area, showing the boundary, the four recorded features (QBE1–QBE4) and the surviving regular tree-planting lines to the east of the site. (Source: WP).

5.4 Gqeberha, Walmer Township And The Segregation History

The site’s south-eastern edge adjoins the Walmer township, known in isiXhosa as Gqeberha (eGqebera). The pattern of "locations" in Port Elizabeth was first established in 1834, when the Colonial Government granted land to the London Missionary Society for a burial ground and residential area at the crest of Hyman’s Kloof (Russell Road). Other workers built closer to their places of employment or to water. Most of these suburbs were informal, and — following political tension within the Port Elizabeth Council — the Municipality adopted its first markedly segregationist regulations in 1885, establishing suburbs on the outskirts of the town, among them Walmer (1896).²⁵

Although the Walmer township area was intended as a "white" suburb, indigenous communities moved into the area as white households and businesses sought to keep their workers close. Under the Group Areas Act of 1955, the township was designated a "whites only" area and the apartheid state sought to remove it; through the strong resistance of the township’s residents — with support from residents of the neighbouring Walmer suburb — Gqeberha was never destroyed, although apartheid authorities long denied it basic infrastructure. This contested history is a significant part of the wider cultural landscape within which the site sits.²⁶

5.5 A Note On Name Changes

²⁵ C. Booth (2014), citing Baines (1989), on the origins of Gqeberha (Walmer township): the 1834 LMS land grant, the 1885 segregationist regulations, the establishment of the Walmer "location" (1896), and its designation under the Group Areas Act (1955).

²⁶ C. Booth (2014), citing Baines (1989), on the origins of Gqeberha (Walmer township): the 1834 LMS land grant, the 1885 segregationist regulations, the establishment of the Walmer "location" (1896), and its designation under the Group Areas Act (1955).

The layered naming of this landscape is itself part of its heritage significance:

- **Welbedacht → "Muller's Town" → Walmer.** The Dutch farm name Welbedacht gave way, on subdivision in the 1850s, to the proposed "Muller's Town" and finally to Walmer, after Walmer Castle in Kent, where the Duke of Wellington died in 1852.²⁷
- **Port Elizabeth → Gqeberha.** The city was officially renamed Gqeberha on 23 February 2021. "Gqeberha" is the isiXhosa name of the Baakens River and of the Walmer township adjoining this site — so the city's present name derives directly from the historical naming of the ground on the site's boundary.²⁸
- **Associated regional changes.** The same process renamed Uitenhage as Kariega and the Port Elizabeth International Airport as the Chief Dawid Stuurman International Airport, after the Khoe leader who resisted colonial rule.²⁹

5.6 Heritage Sites And Structures In The Vicinity

HERITAGE RESOURCE	BRIEF DESCRIPTION
Former farm Welbedacht and the Muller subdivisions	The 1815 farm from which Walmer was laid out; the subdivisions to the Muller heirs are recorded on early maps, and their boundaries survive in current erf lines and on-site fence lines and vegetation.
Walmer Commonage	The historical commonage land (transferred to the Colonial Government in 1893), used for grazing and garden-planting; the present site formed part of this commonage landscape.
Walmer Golf Club ("Little Walmer")	Founded 1897; one of the oldest golf clubs in South Africa; the site's northern/eastern boundary.
Former Arlington Race Course	Historic horse-racing venue immediately to the south-west/east.
Walmer township (eGqeberha)	One of the city's oldest townships; a living community adjoining the south-east and the source of the isiXhosa name now borne by the city.
Port Elizabeth–Avontuur narrow-gauge railway ("Apple Express")	Historic narrow-gauge line to the north of the site.
Recorded features on the site (QBE1–QBE4)	Dipping tank, two ruins and a modern substation (chapter 6).

5.7 Summary Historical Timeline

- **pre-1815:** Khoekhoen pastoralist and earlier Stone Age occupation of the wider coastal landscape; the isiXhosa name Gqeberha attaches to the Baakens River and the area of the later Walmer township.
- **1815:** Farm Welbedacht (±14 square miles) granted to Anthonie Michael Muller.
- **1834:** LMS land grant establishes the pattern of Port Elizabeth "locations".
- **1845:** Muller dies; the farm passes to his eight sons and is sold.
- **1852:** The Duke of Wellington dies at Walmer Castle, Kent.

²⁷ M. Harradine, Port Elizabeth (Historical Society of Port Elizabeth); E.K. Lorimer, Panorama of Port Elizabeth (Balkema, 1971); South African History Online, "Port Elizabeth Timeline 1799–1986"; corroborated by contemporary Eastern Province Herald reports.

²⁸ Department of Sport, Arts and Culture name-change notice, gazetted 23 February 2021; "Gqeberha" is the isiXhosa name of both the Walmer township and the Baakens River.

²⁹ Department of Sport, Arts and Culture name-change notice, gazetted 23 February 2021; "Gqeberha" is the isiXhosa name of both the Walmer township and the Baakens River.

- **1853–1855:** A portion of Welbedacht is laid out as a township; named Walmer; 400 plots offered by auction (8 March 1855).
- **1885 / 1893 / 1896:** Segregationist municipal regulations (1885); Walmer Commonage transferred to the Colonial Government (1893); Walmer "location" established (1896).
- **1897 / 1899:** Walmer Golf Club founded (1897); Walmer awarded separate municipal status (1899).
- **c.1900 / 1906 / 1928:** Tree-planting throughout Walmer; suburban branch railway opens (1906) and is abandoned (1928).
- **c.1930s:** Construction of the QBE3 (and QBE2) structures on the site.
- **1939:** Aerial photography records planting, tree-lines and structures on the site.
- **1955 / mid-1960s:** Group Areas Act designation of Walmer township (1955); Walmer absorbed into Port Elizabeth (mid-1960s).
- **2001:** Nelson Mandela Bay Metropolitan Municipality formed.
- **2014:** Phase 1 AIA (Booth) records the four built-environment features.
- **23 Feb 2021:** Port Elizabeth officially renamed Gqeberha.
- **2019 / 2026:** Environmental Authorisation granted (2019) and lapsed; fresh Scoping and EIA application lodged (2026).

6 THE HERITAGE RESOURCES AND THEIR SIGNIFICANCE

This chapter identifies and describes the heritage resources of the site — the built environment being the focus of this report — and assesses their significance in terms of Section 3(3) of the NHRA and international best practice.

6.1 Palaeontological Aspects

The palaeontological sensitivity of the site is rated Very High on the national screening tool. The site is underlain by the Nanaga and Alexandria Formations (with the Nanaga interpreted as aeolian deposits), which can preserve fossil material. A field-based Palaeontological Impact Assessment and a protocol for chance finds are required; this is addressed by a separate palaeontological specialist, and the finds protocol is incorporated into the mitigation in chapter 8. Any fossil material exposed during earthworks must be reported to the relevant authority and assessed before work continues.³⁰

6.2 Archaeological Aspects

The Phase 1 AIA (Booth 2014) found no surface archaeological material or shell-midden sites within the property, which lies on the boundary of the five-kilometre coastal sensitivity zone. The survey was limited to surface observation and does not exclude sub-surface stone artefacts occurring between the surface and roughly 50–80 cm below ground, beneath the dense vegetation. Pre-colonial archaeological sensitivity is assessed as low, subject to a chance-find protocol for buried material and human remains. Should concentrations of archaeological material or human remains be uncovered, work must stop and the Albany Museum and/or ECPHRA be notified, with a professional archaeologist appointed to assess and, if necessary, undertake Phase 2 mitigation.³¹

6.3 The Built-Environment Heritage Resources

The archaeological report identified four features (QBE1–QBE4). Two building ruins (QBE2 and QBE3) and the dipping tank (QBE1) are recorded on the 1:50 000 topographic map (Sixth Edition, 2002). A further building/ruin recorded on that map but absent from earlier editions (1965 and 1983) is therefore younger than 60 years and was not encountered during the survey. To these four features, this report adds two further heritage resources: the historical association of the site to the Welbedacht farm and the Muller family, and the surviving commonage, garden-planting and tree-grove landscape.³²

6.3.1 QBE1 — Dipping Tank

An unused concrete dipping tank, now overgrown with vegetation, located in the eastern half of the site. It would most probably have been used when the area was still worked as farming or small-holding land, and it likely dates from a later period of that use. Its history is uncertain and it is of low significance. Coordinate: 33°59'52.60"S; 25°34'20.60"E.

³⁰ Abantu Environmental Services (Pty) Ltd, Final Scoping Report: Walmer Housing Development on Erf 11305 (DEDEAT ref. ECm1/C/LN2/M/07-2026), 13 April 2026; and SRK Consulting, Final Scoping Report, 2015.

³¹ C. Booth, A Phase 1 Archaeological Impact Assessment (AIA) for the proposed Walmer Gqeberha Low-Cost Housing Development on Erf 11305, Walmer, Port Elizabeth, NMBM, prepared for SRK Consulting, September 2014.

³² C. Booth, A Phase 1 Archaeological Impact Assessment (AIA) for the proposed Walmer Gqeberha Low-Cost Housing Development on Erf 11305, Walmer, Port Elizabeth, NMBM, prepared for SRK Consulting, September 2014.

6.3.2 QBE2 — Ruin (dwelling)

A minor ruin to the north of the site, in a heavily overgrown area, considered to be of a similar age to QBE3 (from the 1930s). It represents the remains of a dwelling and associated infrastructure. It is older than 60 years but of low–medium significance. Coordinate: 33°59'48.10"S; 25°34'11.00"E.

6.3.3 QBE3 — Ruin (farmstead)

QBE3 is the principal and largest structure recorded on the site, with the remains of its foundations and a prominent stone chimney still standing. From its materials and detailing — brick and concrete walls, roof tile and bathroom wall tile — it is suggested to date, at the earliest, from the 1930s. The plan indicates a modest residence: an approach and veranda to the north, a kitchen to the rear, and evidence of an outside toilet. Its most notable qualities are aesthetic and visual-spatial: its prominent position on a rise, its commanding northward approach and view, and the surviving chimney. It is older than 60 years and of low–medium significance. Coordinate: 33°59'56.70"S; 25°34'30.30"E.



Figure 7: Site QBE3 — the principal farmstead ruin, showing the surviving stone foundations, low walls and chimney, heavily overgrown, on a rise commanding a northward view. (Source: C. Booth, 2014.)

6.3.4 Qbe4 — Substation

A contemporary electrical substation to the west of the site, of no heritage significance. Coordinate: 33°59'51.00"S; 25°34'34.15"E.

6.3.5 The Historical Association Of The Site Itself

It is argued that the most heritage-important aspect of this site is its historical association with the early farms of Port Elizabeth and the creation of the suburb of Walmer — seen in the 1815 Welbedacht grant and the subsequent subdivisions to the Muller heirs. Interested communities that could claim this heritage include descendants of the Muller and related families, and parties interested in the history of Walmer such as the Historical Society and the Genealogy Society. This is a claim to the history and development of the site as recorded in maps and archival sources, rather than to specific structures or tree rows.

6.3.6 Commonages, Garden Planting And Tree Groves

A further modest heritage significance lies in the site's long use as commonage and garden-planting land, and its consequent relationship to the development of the Walmer suburb. Surviving evidence of this — the organised lines and groves of (exotic) trees to the east of the site, contemporary with the c.1900 planting of the suburb — is relatively rare in Port Elizabeth, precisely because ongoing development has destroyed most of it (Figures 5 and 6). This landscape layer is of medium historical and social/economic value and is relatively rare.

6.4 Heritage Significance

The significance framework follows Section 3(3) of the NHRA, Heritage Western Cape grading guidance and international best practice, using historical, aesthetic (architectural and visual-spatial), and social/economic value, moderated by rarity and representativeness.³³ The primary significances of this site are its historical and its social/economic values; both are modest.

Heritage Western Cape notes that historical significance relates to "importance to a community or pattern of history" — here, the development of Walmer and the pattern of commonage and garden-planting — and that social value arises from "a strong or special association with a particular group for social, cultural or spiritual reasons".³⁴ Rarity and representativeness act as moderators, allowing increased value for rare resources or for the collective value of a set of resources.

The significance of the resources is summarised below.

NO	POTENTIAL HERITAGE RESOURCE	OLDER THAN 60 YRS?	SIGNIFICANCE	RARITY / REPRESENTATIVE
1	QBE1 — Dipping tank	Unknown	Low historical	N/A
2	QBE2 — Ruin	Yes	Low–medium historical; low–medium social/economic	Not rare or representative
3	QBE3 — Ruin	Yes	Low–medium historical; low–medium social/economic	Not rare or representative
4	QBE4 — Substation	No	N/A	N/A
5	Historical association of the site itself	Yes	Medium historical; medium social/economic	Relatively rare
6	Commonages, garden planting and tree groves	Yes	Medium historical; medium social/economic	Relatively rare

³³ Heritage Western Cape, A Short Guide to and Policy Statement on Grading, Version 6, 2012.

³⁴ Heritage Western Cape, A Short Guide to and Policy Statement on Grading, Version 6, 2012.

6.4.1 Composite Statement of Significance

Erf 11305, Walmer, is a modestly significant heritage resource, valued chiefly for its historical and social/economic links to the formation of Walmer and to its long use as commonage and garden-planting land. These values are modest, are not necessarily tied to the physical fabric on the site, and are held today by a relatively small community of descendants and interest parties. The four recorded built features are of low–medium (QBE1–QBE3) or no (QBE4) significance; QBE2 and QBE3 are older than 60 years but of low significance. The site’s more distinctive value lies in the associative history of the Welbedacht/Muller subdivision and in the surviving, relatively rare, commonage and tree-planting landscape. There should be no reasonable heritage objection to the demolition of the structures; if graded, they would remain ungraded.

7 PROPOSED WORK AND ALTERNATIVES

The proposed development is a Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality mixed-housing scheme on the ±43.73 ha erf, providing approximately 952 residential opportunities (652 single dwellings and 300 high-density units) across a range of typologies, together with business, institutional, authority, open-space, special-use conservation (forest-patch) and transport zones, internal roads and services. The proposal entails extensive clearing of the site and the removal of existing vegetation and structures.

7.1 Alternatives

The approved layout (Figure 1) is the preferred alternative. Two design-and-layout alternatives were considered in the EIA: Alternative 1 (higher yield, but encroaching on the forest patches) and Alternative 2 (the preferred and approved layout, which avoids and retains the forest patches). The "no-go" alternative would retain the status quo but forgo the substantial housing benefit and leave the forest patches exposed to ongoing pressures. From a built-environment heritage perspective the preferred layout is supported; no layout alternative is required on heritage grounds, since the low–medium-significance ruins do not warrant in-situ retention.

7.2 Drawings

DRAWING NUMBER	DESCRIPTION
DYB-Y-28 (Metroplan)	SPLUMA-approved Rezoning and Subdivision Plan, Erf 11305, Walmer.
EIA layout (Abantu)	Preferred development layout (Alternative 2), forest patches retained.

8 HERITAGE IMPACTS AND MITIGATIONS

This chapter assesses the impact of the development on heritage resources and weighs it against the sustainable social and economic benefits of the development, as required by Section 38 of the NHRA.

8.1 Key Heritage Elements

The resources potentially affected are: the built features QBE1–QBE3 (QBE4 being of no significance); possible sub-surface archaeological material and human remains; palaeontological material (Very High sensitivity, addressed separately); the associative history of the Welbedacht/Muller subdivision; and the commonage/garden-planting landscape.

8.2 Impacts And Mitigations

NO	HERITAGE RESOURCE	HERITAGE IMPACT	HERITAGE MITIGATION
1	QBE2 and QBE3 (ruins, older than 60 years)	Demolition/site clearance removes the surviving structures. Impact before mitigation: Low–Medium negative.	Obtain a Section 38 demolition permit from ECPHRA; before demolition, record the structures photographically and by measured/archival note and lodge the record with ECPHRA/SAHRIS.
2	QBE1 (dipping tank) and QBE4 (substation)	Removal of a low-significance and a non-significant feature respectively.	Photographic record of QBE1 before removal; no mitigation for QBE4.
3	Associative history (Welbedacht/Muller); commonage and tree-groves	Loss of the physical traces of the commonage/garden landscape; the associative history is not physically diminished.	Preserve the historical record (maps, archival material); retain sample tree-lines within open space where feasible.
4	Sub-surface archaeology and human remains	Earthworks could expose buried material or graves. Impact before mitigation: Low negative (low likelihood).	Chance-find protocol: stop work, protect the find, notify the ECPHRA, appoint an archaeologist.
5	Palaeontological material (Very High sensitivity)	Earthworks could disturb fossil material.	Apply the finds protocol of the separate PIA; ECO monitoring. (Addressed by other specialist.)

8.3 Cumulative Impacts And Socio-Economic Considerations

The development forms part of the continuing suburban and township expansion at the western edge of Walmer (including the related housing on Erf 1948). The cumulative built-environment heritage impact is modest: the affected resources are common, low–medium-significance ruins whose loss, mitigated by recording, does not materially diminish the regional heritage resource base; the retention of the forest patches is a positive outcome.

Section 38 requires the heritage impact to be weighed against the development's benefits, which are substantial: approximately 952 housing opportunities on municipal land, without displacement, directed at vulnerable households and the "missing middle", together with construction employment.

On balance, the social and economic benefit clearly outweighs the low, mitigable heritage cost, and there is no heritage fatal flaw.

9 RECOMMENDATION AND WAY FORWARD

Our reasoned opinion is that the proposed Walmer Housing Development on Erf 11305 should be supported and authorised from a built-environment heritage perspective. The site is of only modest heritage value; the structures are of low–medium significance and, if graded, would remain ungraded; and the heritage impact is minimal and readily mitigable. The heritage value can be maintained through the preservation of historical information (maps and archival documentation) and modest interpretation, and should not hamper the development of the site. The substantial social and economic benefit of the housing clearly outweighs the modest heritage cost.

9.1 Legislative Way Forward

1. Lodge a Notification of Intent to Develop (NID) with ECPHRA, indicating the limited significance of the heritage resources.
2. On the strength of this HIA, apply to ECPHRA for a Section 38 permit for the demolition of the structures (QBE2 and QBE3), preceded by photographic and archival recording.
3. Once the above approvals are obtained, no further heritage action is anticipated unless new information is unearthed.

9.2 Unearthing And Recording

Should further information be unearthed during development — further structures, human remains, "middens" or other evidence of human habitation — it is the responsibility of the owner to contact the relevant authority and declare the findings. All demolitions and unearthing's are to be recorded photographically.

9.3 Conclusion

Although an interesting part of the history of Port Elizabeth/Gqeberha and of Walmer specifically, this site is of only modest heritage value. That value can be maintained through the preservation of historical information and modest interpretation, and should not warrant hampering the development of the site. Subject to the conditions above — a Section 34 permit and recording for QBE2 and QBE3, chance-find protocols, and the interpretive panel — the proposed development is acceptable on built-environment heritage grounds.

10 SOURCES

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11 LIST OF ANNEXURES

- Annexure 1: Notification of Intent to Develop (NID)
- Annexure 2: Survey information
- Annexure 3: Drawings
- Annexure 4: Letter of Authority
- Annexure 5: Extract from title deeds

12 ANNEXURE 1: NOTIFICATION OF INTENT TO DEVELOP (NID)

See separate document, to be lodged with ECPHRA/SAHRIS as part of the EIA process.

13 ANNEXURE 2: SURVEY INFORMATION

Surveyor-General 21-digit code C059003800130500000; extent ±43.73 ha; Registration Division Port Elizabeth. See Figures 1 and 4.

14 ANNEXURE 3: DRAWINGS

SPLUMA-approved Rezoning and Subdivision Plan (Metroplan DYB-Y-28) and the preferred EIA layout (Abantu).

15 ANNEXURE 4: LETTER OF AUTHORITY AND CV

To be attached.

16 ANNEXURE 5: EXTRACT FROM TITLE DEEDS

To be attached: extract from the title deed for Erf 11305, Walmer, confirming ownership by the Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality.